

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 5: सेवा हि परमो धर्मः (Seva Hi Paramo Dharmah)

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	5 — सेवा हि परमो धर्मः (Seva Hi Paramo Dharmah)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. National-Olympiad traps: परमः is a superlative of RANK (highest), never of TIME (first/earliest), and the comparative भाव it implies is 'outranks all others', not 'is the only one'; हि is a confirming/causal emphatic (इव/एव-family 'verily, indeed'), never interrogative, negative, or a conjunction, and dropping it leaves a grammatical but flatter assertion; the सन्धि परमः+धर्मः→परमो धर्मः is विसर्ग→ओ before a voiced soft consonant (ध), governed by the FOLLOWING sound being voiced — not by धर्मः being a noun; सेव् is आत्मनेपदी (सेवते) governing the accusative object, so the server is the doctor (subject) and the served are रोगिणः (acc. pl., ण by णत्व); चिकित्सकः is an अ-stem AGENT in -क, रोगिन् an इन्-stem CHARACTERISED-BY noun whose nom. sg. masks the न् (रोगी) revealed obliquely; -वत् in यन्त्रवत् is the इव/'like' तद्धित (manner of tireless steady action), not the possessive 'having'; -ईय in मानवीय makes a 'befitting-a-human' adjective that must agree in gender/number with its noun; कषाय flips between क्वाथ (decoction/medicine) and the astringent रस purely by CONTEXT, never by gender or number; and सेवा (time+body+presence) is categorically distinct from दान (transfer of money/goods at a distance) even when both help. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A logician restates सेवा हि परमो धर्मः as a ranking claim. Which restatement preserves EXACTLY what परमः (superlative of rank) asserts — no more, no less?

- (A) Service is the single duty that exists; all other so-called duties are illusory.
- (B) Service is the duty one should perform earliest each day, before all others.
- (C) Among all duties, service occupies the highest rank; other genuine duties exist but none surpasses it.
- (D) Service and every other duty share equal rank, none above another.

2. If one weakened परमः to a plain positive adjective so the line read 'service is a duty', what specifically would be lost compared with 'service is the HIGHEST duty'?

- (A) The emphasis carried by हि, which depends entirely on परमः being a superlative.
- (B) The comparative ranking — service would merely be one duty among many, no longer placed above all the rest.
- (C) The meaning of सेवा, which can only mean 'service' when परमः is present.
- (D) The grammatical completeness of the sentence, which would become a fragment.

3. A student claims हि and a hypothetical interrogative particle would do the same job in सेवा हि परमो धर्मः. The sharpest reason this is wrong is that हि:

- (A) negates the clause, which an interrogative would not.
- (B) is a conjunction joining two clauses, while an interrogative joins none.
- (C) changes the case of धर्मः, while an interrogative changes the case of सेवा.
- (D) confirms and intensifies the assertion ('service is verily the highest duty'), whereas an interrogative would turn it into a question and remove the claim entirely.

4. To coin 'patience is verily the highest virtue' on the EXACT structure of सेवा हि परमो धर्मः, which mapping of the four slots (subject — emphatic — superlative — predicate-noun) is correct?

- (A) patience → धर्मः-slot; virtue → सेवा-slot; verily → परमः-slot; highest → हि-slot.
- (B) patience → परमः-slot; highest → सेवा-slot; verily → धर्मः-slot; virtue → हि-slot.
- (C) patience → सेवा-slot; verily → हि-slot; highest → परमो/परमः-slot; virtue → धर्मः-slot.
- (D) patience → हि-slot; verily → सेवा-slot; highest → धर्मः-slot; virtue → परमः-slot.

5. The chapter's deepest moral abstraction is best stated as:

- (A) A person's worth is measured by humane service rendered, not by the credentials or rank they accumulate.
- (B) A person's worth is fixed by the number of degrees and posts they hold.
- (C) Service matters only when it is rewarded with a higher position.
- (D) Wealth, once donated, automatically becomes the highest form of duty.

6. Why does the chapter dramatise its thesis through a PHYSICIAN rather than simply stating the maxim?

- (A) A concrete agent who chooses bedside service over titles makes the abstract ranking of duties vivid and checkable against a life lived.
- (B) Because only physicians are capable of performing the highest duty.
- (C) Because a maxim about duty is grammatically impossible to state without an example.
- (D) Because the chapter is primarily a manual of medical vocabulary, not ethics.

7. The pre-sandhi (split) form of the whole line सेवा हि परमो धर्मः is:

- (A) सेवाः हि परमः धर्मः
- (B) सेवा हि परमः धर्मः
- (C) सेवा हि परमम् धर्मः
- (D) सेवा हि परमो धर्मो

8. परमः becomes परमो specifically because the next word धर्मः begins with ध्. The TRUE conditioning factor is that ध् is:

- (A) the first letter of a noun, and विसर्ग becomes ओ only before nouns.
- (B) an aspirated letter, and विसर्ग becomes ओ only before aspirates.
- (C) a voiced (soft) consonant, before which final विसर्ग (from -अः) turns to ओ.
- (D) a retroflex letter, and विसर्ग becomes ओ only before retroflexes.

9. By the SAME विसर्ग rule that gives परमो धर्मः, which join is performed CORRECTLY?

- (A) रामः + पठति → रामो पठति
- (B) रामः + करोति → रामो करोति
- (C) रामः + तिष्ठति → रामो तिष्ठति
- (D) रामः + गच्छति → रामो गच्छति

10. If परमः stood at the END of a sentence (in pause), with nothing following, its final विसर्ग would:

- (A) become ओ anyway — परमो — since once a word can take ओ it always does.
- (B) disappear entirely, leaving परम.
- (C) remain as विसर्ग — परमः — because the ओ change needs a following voiced sound to trigger it.
- (D) become र्, leaving परमर्.

11. Consider परमः + अयम्. The result is परमोऽयम्. Compared with परमो धर्मः, what makes this case different even though both show ओ?

- (A) Here ओ appears for no reason, since अ is not a voiced consonant.
- (B) Here the two words must be written with a space and no अवग्रह.
- (C) Here -अः meets a following अ; the अ is absorbed and marked by अवग्रह (ऽ), whereas before धर्मः a whole consonant follows and no अवग्रह appears.
- (D) Here परमः does not change at all, so परमोऽयम् is an error.

12. If the motto were rephrased परमो धर्मः सेवा एव, the join सेवा + एव (आ + ए) correctly yields:

- (A) सेवेव (आ + ए → ए)
- (B) सेवैव (आ + ए → ऐ)
- (C) सेवाएव (no change)
- (D) सेवायेव

13. A philanthropist endows a hospital, funds its medicines for years, but never once enters a ward. Strictly by the chapter's सेवा/दान boundary, this is:

- (A) सेवा — because sustained help to the sick is service by any reasonable measure.
- (B) दान — a transfer of resources at a distance, lacking the personal time and presence that defines सेवा.
- (C) both सेवा and दान equally, since funding and presence amount to the same help.
- (D) neither, because endowments fall outside both categories.

14. Helper X wires money for a patient's care; Helper Y sits nightly with the patient, feeds him, prepares his कषायम्, but has no money to give. The chapter would rank these as:

- (A) X performs सेवा (the real help) and Y merely assists.
- (B) Y performs सेवा and X performs दान; the chapter exalts Y's सेवा as the higher duty.

(C) both perform सेवा, since each helps the same patient.

(D) both perform दान, since both are forms of giving.

15. WHY, while honouring both, does the chapter crown सेवा rather than दान as परमो धर्मः?

The best reason is:

(A) दान is morally tainted, so only सेवा can qualify as a duty.

(B) दान is beyond the means of ordinary people, so it cannot be ranked.

(C) सेवा is cheaper and easier, making it the more practical duty.

(D) सेवा demands the giver's own time, body and presence — a more personal and costly self-giving than parting with money alone.

16. Which scenario is सेवा with NO element of दान whatsoever?

(A) A tycoon who anonymously wires funds to an orphanage each month.

(B) A donor who builds a hospital wing he never visits.

(C) A trust that ships free medicine overseas to strangers.

(D) A penniless student who spends every evening reading aloud and tending to a blind elder.

17. A child reasons: 'दान helps people, and सेवा helps people, so they must be the same duty.'

The precise flaw is that the child:

(A) wrongly assumes दान helps anyone at all, when it never does.

(B) confuses the gender of the two nouns, which actually decides their meaning.

(C) forgets that सेवा means giving money and दान means giving time.

(D) treats a shared outcome (helping) as proof of identical means, ignoring that दान transfers resources from afar while सेवा gives one's own presence.

18. सेव् ('to serve') is आत्मनेपदी and governs the accusative. The correctly formed clause for 'the physician serves the sick (pl.)' is:

(A) चिकित्सकः रोगिणः सेवते

(B) चिकित्सकः रोगिभ्यः सेवति

(C) चिकित्सकं रोगिणः सेवते

(D) चिकित्सकः रोगिणाम् सेवयति

19. In चिकित्सकः रोगिणः सेवते, the accusative रोगिणः shows ण rather than न्. The reason is:

(A) णत्व — the र् earlier in रोग- causes a following न् to retroflex into ण within the same word.

(B) accusative plural endings universally carry ण in every noun.

(C) इन्-stems replace every consonant in the word with its retroflex counterpart.

(D) the आत्मनेपद verb सेवते forces ण onto its object.

20. रोगी (nom. sg.) ends in ई, yet grammarians list it under रोगिन् (an इन्-stem). The correct account is:

(A) रोगी is truly an ई-stem like नदी, and रोगिन् is a misprint.

(B) The stem is रोगिन्; in the nominative singular the न् drops and इ lengthens to ई, giving रोगी, while oblique cases restore the न् (रोगिणम्, रोगिणः).

(C) रोगी and रोगिन् are unrelated lookalikes with separate declensions.

(D) रोगी is simply the feminine of masculine रोगिन्.

21. If TWO physicians served ONE sick man, the subject and object forms become, respectively:

(A) चिकित्सकौ (nom. dual) and रोगिणम् (acc. sg.)

(B) चिकित्सकाः (nom. pl.) and रोगिणः (acc. pl.)

(C) चिकित्सकौ (nom. dual) and रोगिणौ (acc. dual) (D) चिकित्सकम् (acc. sg.) and रोगी (nom. sg.)

22. Keeping सेव् in आत्मनेपद, 'I serve the sick daily' uses which verb form?

(A) सेवामि (1st sg. परस्मैपद)

(B) सेवसे (2nd sg. आत्मनेपद)

(C) सेवामहे (1st pl. आत्मनेपद)

(D) सेवे (1st person singular, आत्मनेपद)

23. Because सेव् governs the accusative, 'serves the king (नृप)' is correctly:

(A) नृपाय सेवते

(B) नृपेण सेवते

(C) नृपं सेवते

(D) नृपस्य सेवते

24. चिकित्सकः carries -क and रोगिन् carries -इन्. Building 'one who teaches (अध्यापक root)' and 'one who has wealth (धन)' on the SAME two patterns gives:

(A) अध्यापिन् (-इन्) and धनकः (-क)

(B) अध्यापकः (-क) and धनकः (-क)

(C) अध्यापकः (agent -क) and धनिन् (possessive/characterising -इन्)

(D) अध्यापिन् (-इन्) and धनिन् (-इन्)

25. यन्त्रवत् is glossed यन्त्रम् इव. The -वत् here is the तद्धित meaning 'like'. Which coinage uses -वत् in this SAME 'like' sense?

(A) अग्निवत् — 'like fire' (blazing, fierce) (B) धनवत् — 'having wealth'

(C) बुद्धिवत् — 'possessing intelligence' (D) पुत्रवत् — 'having a son'

26. Praising the doctor as यन्त्रवत् rests on a machine's specific quality. What quality is the chapter borrowing?

(A) Being built of metal and gears.

(B) Tireless, steady, repetitive action that never flags.

(C) Being modern, costly equipment.

(D) Being coldly indifferent to those it serves.

27. Calling a nurse 'सरितवत्' (river-like) on the यन्त्रवत् model would most aptly praise:

(A) her continuous, never-stopping flow of care, like a river that keeps moving.

(B) her ownership of a river.

(C) her cold and rigid manner.

(D) her tendency to overflow and cause harm.

28. उपाधिः and पदवी are easily confused. Which mapping is correct?

(A) उपाधिः = the post one holds; पदवी = the qualification one earns.

(B) उपाधिः = the qualification one earns by study (a degree); पदवी = the post or rank one holds.

(C) उपाधि: = a herbal decoction; पदवी = a machine.

(D) both mean an academic degree.

29. A surgeon is offered the role 'Head of Department' and separately awarded an honorary doctorate. In the chapter's words these are, respectively:

(A) उपाधि: (a post held) and पदवी (a degree)(B) both पदवी

(C) पदवी (a post held) and उपाधि: (a qualification/degree)

(D) both उपाधि:

30. The chapter says the doctor 'set aside the pursuit of उपाधि: AND पदवी'. Naming BOTH rather than one shows that he renounced:

(A) only academic study, while still chasing high office.

(B) every kind of outward distinction — both academic credentials and official rank — for the sake of service.

(C) only high office, while still chasing degrees.

(D) his medical practice itself, along with the titles.

31. Which single line correctly states the chapter's ranking among सेवा, उपाधि: and पदवी?

(A) उपाधि: outranks सेवा, since without a degree no one may serve.

(B) सेवा outranks both उपाधि: and पदवी; the degree and the post are mere trappings, while service is the supreme duty.

(C) पदवी outranks सेवा, since rank confers the power to serve.

(D) All three rank equally, since each helps people in its way.

32. मानवीया: is built as मानव ('human') + the तद्धित -ईय. The parallel adjective from देव ('god') on the same pattern is:

(A) देववत् ('like a god', with -वत्)

(B) देविन् ('having a god', with -इन्)

(C) दैव / दैवीय ('pertaining to / befitting a god', with -ईय and वृद्धि of the first vowel)

(D) देवक: ('one who gods', with -क)

33. मानवीया: (nom. pl. masc.) modifies गुणाः. If it instead modified the single feminine noun सेवा, the agreeing form would be:

(A) मानवीया (feminine singular) — मानवीया सेवा(B) मानवीया: (unchanged)

(C) मानवीयम् (neuter singular)

(D) मानवीयान् (masculine accusative plural)

34. कषाय carries two senses — a herbal decoction (क्वाथ) and one of the six tastes. The TASTE sense of कषाय is:

(A) sweet (मधुर)

(B) sour (अम्ल)

(C) bitter (तिक्त)

(D) astringent

35. In the chapter's bedside scene कषायम् means a decoction (medicine). The decisive clue fixing this over the 'astringent taste' sense is:

(A) the gender of the word कषायम्.

(B) the CONTEXT — the doctor is preparing it to treat a sick patient.

(C) the grammatical number (singular vs plural).

(D) the position of the word in the sentence.

36. A cookery note reads भोजने कषायः रसः अस्ति ('there is a कषाय रस in the food'). Here कषाय means:

(A) a herbal decoction served as a drink (B) the astringent taste

(C) an Ayurvedic medicine for the sick (D) a doctor's written prescription

37. Map each word to the suffix that builds it: चिकित्सक, रोगिन्, यन्त्रवत्, मानवीय.

(A) -क (agent), -इन् (characterising/possessive), -वत् ('like'), -ईय ('befitting/pertaining to')

(B) -इन्, -क, -ईय, -वत् (in that order) (C) all four use -क

(D) -वत्, -ईय, -क, -इन् (in that order)

38. Exactly ONE of these word-meaning pairs is wrong. Identify it.

(A) उपाधिः = a degree (correct)

(B) कषायम् = a herbal decoction (correct)

(C) पदवी = a herbal decoction (WRONG — पदवी is a post/position)

(D) मानवीयाः = humane (correct)

39. Which role-and-suffix description is entirely correct?

(A) चिकित्सकः is the agent who heals (-क); रोगिन् is the one characterised by रोग, the sick (-इन्); the physician serves the sick.

(B) चिकित्सकः is the sick (-इन्); रोगिन् is the healer (-क).

(C) both चिकित्सकः and रोगिन् name the medicine. (D) चिकित्सकः takes -इन् and रोगिन् takes -क.

40. Putting यन्त्रवत् and मानवीयाः गुणाः together, the IDEAL servant the chapter paints is one who is:

(A) cold and mechanical in every respect, feelings included.

(B) warm-hearted but quick to tire and give up.

(C) tireless in effort like a machine (यन्त्रवत्) yet warm and humane in spirit (मानवीयाः) — machine-like in stamina, human in heart.

(D) indifferent both in effort and in feeling.

41. A clinic posts: 'We hire only doctors with the highest उपाधिः and पदवी.' The chapter's likeliest critique is:

(A) the clinic is right — only degrees and posts make a good doctor.

(B) credentials and posts are not the true measure of a healer; सेवा and humane care matter more.

(C) the clinic should instead hire only the wealthiest doctors.

(D) the clinic should value machines (यन्त्र) over doctors.

42. Read this layered claim and pick the fully correct correction: 'चिकित्सकः रोगी सेवति — the sick man serves the doctor, working यन्त्रवत् because he owns a machine.'

(A) The sentence is fully correct as written.

(B) Only the verb is wrong; the roles and यन्त्रवत् are fine.

- (C) It should be चिकित्सकः रोगिणः सेवते — the PHYSICIAN serves the SICK; सेवते is आत्मनेपदः; and यन्त्रवत् means 'LIKE a machine' (tireless), not owning one.
- (D) Only यन्त्रवत् is wrong; the sick man does serve the doctor.

43. A student paraphrases: 'सेवा हि परमो धर्मः means doing one's morning duty first is the supreme service.' How many DISTINCT errors does this contain?

- (A) Zero — the paraphrase is correct. (B) One — only the परमः error.
- (C) Three — परमः, सेवा and हि are all mistranslated.
- (D) Two — it misreads परमः as 'first in time' and it swaps subject and predicate so that service becomes the predicate instead of the subject.

44. Synthesising the whole lesson, the doctor BEST proves सेवा हि परमो धर्मः because, in one chain, he:

- (A) renounces उपाधिः and पदवी, works यन्त्रवत् with मानवीयाः गुणाः, and tirelessly serves रोगिणः — every choice ranking service above outward distinction.
- (B) earns the most उपाधिः, wins the top पदवी, and treats only the wealthy.
- (C) donates money from afar (दान) without ever attending a patient.
- (D) works यन्त्रवत् but only when paid, ignoring मानवीयाः गुणाः.

45. Which single sentence simultaneously (a) honours परमः = 'highest rank', (b) keeps सेवा distinct from दान, and (c) reflects the यन्त्रवत्+मानवीय balance?

- (A) Service ranks highest among duties; rendered in person rather than from afar, it is given tirelessly yet with a warm, humane heart.
- (B) Service is the first duty of the morning, best done by sending money tirelessly.
- (C) Giving money from afar is the highest duty, done coldly and mechanically.
- (D) Service is one of many equal duties, best done by chasing titles humanely.

46. The chapter can be read as a contrast between 'what one HAS' and 'what one DOES'. Mapping its key words correctly:

- (A) HAS: सेवा and कषायम्; DOES: उपाधिः and पदवी.
- (B) HAS: मानवीयाः गुणाः; DOES: उपाधिः and पदवी.
- (C) all the key words name things one merely HAS.
- (D) HAS: उपाधिः and पदवी (degree, post); DOES: सेवा — the tireless serving of रोगिणः with मानवीयाः गुणाः.

47. A debater claims: 'The chapter really champions degrees, since it keeps naming उपाधिः and पदवी.' The sharpest rebuttal is:

- (A) it names उपाधिः and पदवी precisely to rank them BELOW सेवा — naming them is part of showing the doctor renounces their pursuit.
- (B) it never mentions उपाधिः or पदवी, so the debater invented them.
- (C) it does value degrees over service, so the debater is correct.
- (D) it treats degrees, posts and service as exactly equal in worth.

48. A brilliant surgeon with every degree refuses to treat any patient who cannot pay. By the chapter's standard, what does he most fundamentally lack?

- (A) additional उपाधि: to qualify him further.(B) a higher पदवी within his hospital.
- (C) greater personal wealth to draw upon.
- (D) the spirit of सेवा and the मानवीया: गुणा: that make service the highest duty.

49. Two volunteers feed flood victims. A tires after an hour and quits; B works steadily all day without flagging, yet snaps harshly at those she feeds. The chapter's verdict is that:

- (A) B is the perfect servant, since tireless effort is all the chapter asks.
- (B) B has the यन्त्रवत् stamina but lacks मानवीया: गुणा:, while A lacks the stamina — the ideal needs both together.
- (C) A is the perfect servant, since gentleness outweighs endurance entirely.
- (D) both equally fulfil the chapter's ideal of service.

50. Suppose a parallel maxim were coined: दानं हि परमो धर्मः. Within the SAME chapter's framework, the chief objection to substituting दानम् for सेवा would be that:

- (A) दानम् cannot grammatically fill the सेवा slot, so the line is impossible to form.
- (B) दानम् means the same as सेवा, making the substitution pointless rather than wrong.
- (C) दानम् is a verb, so it cannot serve as the subject of a maxim.
- (D) the chapter deliberately ranks सेवा above दान, so dropping presence in favour of mere giving would lower, not raise, the duty being crowned.

51. In चिकित्सकः रोगिणः सेवते, a beginner objects that रोगिणः 'must be genitive singular, the doctor of the sick'. The decisive grammatical reason this object reading is right and the objection wrong is:

- (A) रोगिणः can only ever be genitive, so the sentence must be mistranslated.
- (B) सेव् takes a genitive object, so 'doctor of the sick' is in fact correct.
- (C) the doctor is the object and रोगिणः the subject, reversing the roles.
- (D) सेव् takes its object in the accusative, and रोगिणः here is the accusative PLURAL of रोगिन् ('the sick' as objects served), not a genitive.

52. Which derivation is internally consistent with the chapter's suffix system?

- (A) सेवक (one who serves) takes agent -क like चिकित्सक, and would name the SERVER, parallel to the healer.
- (B) सेवक takes -इन्, so it names the one who is served, like रोगिन्.
- (C) सेवक takes -वत्, so it means 'like service'.
- (D) सेवक takes -ईय, so it means 'befitting service'.

53. Why is it imprecise to translate यन्त्रवत् सेवते simply as 'serves with a machine'?

- (A) -वत् here means 'like' (manner), so it describes HOW he serves — tirelessly like a machine — not an instrument he serves with.
- (B) because 'with a machine' would need यन्त्रेण, but the sentence has no verb to govern an instrument.

(C) because यन्त्र never refers to a machine, only to a tool of the mind.

(D) because सेवते cannot take any adverbial modifier at all.

54. A student insists 'परमो' and 'धर्मः' must be a compound (समास) because they stand together. The best correction is:

(A) they form a तत्पुरुष compound meaning 'duty of the highest'.

(B) they form a द्वन्द्व compound meaning 'the highest and the duty'.

(C) परमो is an indeclinable prefix permanently fused to धर्मः.

(D) they are not a compound but an adjective agreeing with its noun — परमः धर्मः ('highest duty') — joined only by विसर्ग सन्धि (परमः → परमो) at the word boundary.

55. If the line were pluralised to mean 'service-acts are verily the highest duties', the predicate would shift to plural. The correctly agreeing plural of परमः धर्मः is:

(A) परमो धर्माः (adjective singular, noun plural)

(B) परमाः धर्मः (adjective plural, noun singular)(C) परमौ धर्मौ (both dual)

(D) परमाः धर्माः (nom. pl., adjective and noun both plural)

56. Consider the inference: 'Because the doctor prepares कषायम् himself, his service is concrete, not merely verbal.' The hidden assumption that makes this inference valid is:

(A) that कषायम् here means the astringent taste rather than a decoction.

(B) that personally performing a tangible act of care (making the medicine) counts as enacted service rather than mere words.

(C) that preparing medicine earns the doctor a higher उपाधिः.

(D) that the doctor delegates the preparation to an assistant.

57. A motto-writer wants the strongest possible form of 'X is the highest duty' and asks whether to keep or drop हि. The chapter's usage suggests:

(A) drop हि — it weakens the claim by hinting at doubt.

(B) drop हि — it turns the statement into a question.

(C) keep हि — it adds confirming emphasis ('verily'), making the claim more forceful than the bare assertion would be.

(D) keep हि — but only because it is grammatically required to complete the sentence.

58. Pulling the whole chapter into one precise thesis statement, सेवा हि परमो धर्मः is best unpacked as:

(A) 'A degree is verily the highest duty' — shown by a doctor amassing the most उपाधिः.

(B) 'Wealth is verily the highest duty' — shown by a donor giving the largest दान.

(C) 'Service is verily the highest duty' — shown by a doctor who, working tirelessly yet humanely, sets aside degrees and posts to serve the sick in person rather than merely giving from afar.

(D) 'A position is verily the highest duty' — shown by a doctor winning the top पदवी.

59. Apply the विसर्ग rule of परमो धर्मः to a chapter phrase: चिकित्सकः + धावति. The correctly joined form is:

- (A) चिकित्सकः धावति (no change) (B) चिकित्सक् धावति
(C) चिकित्सको धावति (D) चिकित्सका धावति

60. A community leader argues: 'Our village honours its richest donor as its greatest servant.' Judged by the chapter, the flaw in this honour is that it:

- (A) correctly identifies the donor, since the largest giver is by definition the greatest servant.
(B) errs only in calling the act 'great', though दान and सेवा are otherwise the same act.
(C) fails because दान is morally wrong and cannot be honoured at all.
(D) mistakes दान (giving wealth from afar) for सेवा (service given through one's own presence), and so crowns the wrong thing as greatest.

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 5: सेवा हि परमो धर्मः (Seva Hi Paramo Dharmah) — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	A	31	B	41	B	51	D
2	B	12	B	22	D	32	C	42	C	52	A
3	D	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	D	53	A
4	C	14	B	24	C	34	D	44	A	54	D
5	A	15	D	25	A	35	B	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	D	26	B	36	B	46	D	56	B
7	B	17	D	27	A	37	A	47	A	57	C
8	C	18	A	28	B	38	C	48	D	58	C
9	D	19	A	29	C	39	A	49	B	59	C
10	C	20	B	30	B	40	C	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** A superlative of rank places one item at the top of an existing set; it does not deny the rest of the set, nor reorder it by time, nor flatten the ranking to equality. Saying service is highest concedes other duties are real yet subordinate.
- (B)** परमः supplies the top-of-set ranking. Strip it and service is asserted to be a duty but not ranked above others; the loss is precisely the comparative supremacy, independent of हि and of the noun meanings.
- (D)** The two particles pull in opposite directions: हि strengthens a stated truth, while a question particle suspends the truth to ask about it. हि neither negates, conjoins, nor governs case.
- (C)** The subject (the thing ranked) maps to सेवा, the emphatic to हि, the ranking superlative to परमः, and the category it tops to धर्मः. Patience is the subject, verily the emphatic, highest the superlative, virtue the category.

- 5. (A)** The lesson contrasts outward distinctions with inward, enacted compassion and locates true worth in the latter. Credentials, reward, and remote donation are exactly what the chapter ranks below served compassion.
- 6. (A)** An exemplar lets the reader test the abstract claim against observable choices. The physician is illustrative, not exclusive; the maxim stands on its own grammatically; and the ethics, not the vocabulary, is the point.
- 7. (B)** Only परमो needs undoing: it is परमः before the सन्धि. सेवा and धर्मः are unchanged; सेवा is singular (not सेवाः), and परमम् would be a wrong neuter accusative.
- 8. (C)** The rule keys on voicing of the following sound, not on its grammatical category, aspiration, or place of articulation. ध् is voiced, so -अः → ओ.
- 9. (D)** The -अः → ओ change happens only before a VOICED consonant. ग् is voiced (रामो गच्छति is right); प्, क्, and त् are voiceless, so विसर्ग does not become ओ there.
- 10. (C)** Sandhi is conditioned by what follows. With nothing following, there is no voiced trigger, so the विसर्ग simply stays. The ओ form is not an inherent property of the word.
- 11. (C)** Both yield ओ, but before a following अ the अ is elided and shown by अवग्रह (परमोऽयम्); before a voiced consonant like ध् there is no vowel to elide, hence no अवग्रह.
- 12. (B)** वृद्धि-सन्धि fuses आ + ए into ऐ, so सेवा + एव → सेवैव. The other forms misapply or skip the vowel sandhi.
- 13. (B)** The chapter fixes सेवा to the giving of one's own time, body and presence. Money sent without presence — however generous and sustained — is दान, not सेवा.
- 14. (B)** Presence-with-the-body is सेवा (Y); resource-transfer-from-afar is दान (X). The thesis ranks service highest, so Y's contribution is the exalted one even without money.
- 15. (D)** The crowning rests on the depth of self-giving: presence engages the whole person, money only one's surplus. The distractors wrongly condemn दान, gate it by wealth, or invert the difficulty.
- 16. (D)** सेवा pure of दान is presence and effort with no transfer of money or goods. The student gives only time and care; the other three give resources from a distance, which is दान.
- 17. (D)** Two acts can share an end yet differ in means; the chapter distinguishes them precisely by means (presence vs transfer). दान does help, gender is irrelevant, and the child has the two definitions backwards in the last option.
- 18. (A)** Subject in nominative (चिकित्सकः), object in accusative plural (रोगिणः), verb आत्मनेपद 3rd-sg (सेवते). सेवति/सेवयति are wrong voices/forms; रोगिभ्यः and रोगिणाम् are wrong cases;

चिकित्सकं would make the doctor the object.

19. (A) णत्व is triggered by a preceding र्/ष् retroflexing a later न् → ण; it is a property of रोगिन्'s phonology, not of the case ending, not of all consonants, and not of the verb's voice.

20. (B) इन्-stems mask the न् in the nominative singular (where it drops and the vowel lengthens) but reveal it in oblique forms. रोगी is therefore the surface nom. sg. of रोगिन्, not a different stem, lookalike, or feminine.

21. (A) Two physicians is nominative DUAL (चिकित्सकौ); one sick man as object is accusative SINGULAR of रोगिन्, which is रोगिणम् (ण by णत्व). The others mismatch number or swap subject/object cases.

22. (D) आत्मनेपद 1st-sg present is सेवे. सेवामि is the wrong (परस्मैपद) voice, सेवसे is 'you serve', and सेवामहे is 'we serve'.

23. (C) The object of सेव् stands in the accusative: नृपं. Dative (नृपाय), instrumental (नृपेण), and genitive (नृपस्य) would all misassign the object's case.

24. (C) -क builds the agent (अध्यापकः, 'teacher'), -इन् builds the 'one characterised by/having' (धनिन्, 'wealthy'). Swapping or doubling the suffixes breaks the agent/possessive split.

25. (A) -वत् has two senses: 'like' (इव) and 'having/possessing'. यन्त्रवत् uses 'like'. अग्निवत् 'like fire' matches; धनवत्, बुद्धिवत्, पुत्रवत् all use the possessive sense.

26. (B) The comparison praises stamina and constancy, not the machine's material, price, or coldness — indeed the chapter pairs this stamina with मानवीय warmth, so coldness is the opposite of the point.

27. (A) By the 'like' सेंस of -वत्, सरितवत् borrows the river's salient quality of ceaseless flow — apt for unflagging care. 'Ownership' is the wrong sense, and rigidity/harm are not a river's praiseworthy traits.

28. (B) उपाधि: names an earned credential, पदवी names a held office. The distractors swap them, confuse them with कषाय/यन्त्र, or collapse the distinction.

29. (C) A department headship is a held post → पदवी; an honorary doctorate is an earned/conferred credential → उपाधि:. Swapping or merging the two is the trap.

30. (B) Listing both the degree and the post is a totalising move: ALL outward marks of status are set down. It does not mean he keeps one while dropping the other, nor that he abandons medicine.

31. (B) परमो धर्मः places सेवा at the top; उपाधि: and पदवी are subordinated as outward distinctions. The distractors invert the ranking or flatten it to equality.

32. (C) The -ईय तद्धित (with initial वृद्धि) yields दैव/दैवीय 'befitting a god', exactly paralleling मानव→मानवीय. -वत्, -इन्, -क are different suffixes with different meanings.

33. (A) An -ईय adjective agrees with its noun in gender, number and case. A feminine singular नोन needs मानवीया. Keeping the masc.-pl. form, or shifting to neuter/accusative, breaks agreement.

34. (D) Among the six रसाः, कषाय is the astringent taste. Sweet, sour and bitter are मधुर, अम्ल and तिक्त respectively — distinct tastes.

35. (B) कषाय flips sense purely by context. A medical, treatment scene fixes the 'decoction' reading. Gender, number and word-order do not decide between the two senses.

36. (B) The word रस ('taste') and a food context fix the taste sense — astringent. The medical/decoction readings belong to a treatment context, which is absent here.

37. (A) चिकित्सक uses agent -क, रोगिन् uses characterising -इन्, यन्त्रवत् uses 'like' -वत्, मानवीय uses -ईय. The other orderings mis-pair the suffixes or wrongly assign -क to all.

38. (C) पदवी means a held post/rank, not a decoction; the decoction is कषायम्. The other three pairings are accurate.

39. (A) Agent -क names the healer (चिकित्सकः); characterising -इन् names the sick (रोगिन्); the doctor is subject, the sick the object. The distractors swap roles or suffixes.

40. (C) The two images are complementary: borrow the machine's stamina, keep the human's warmth. Taking the machine image to mean coldness, or dropping the stamina, misses the deliberate balance.

41. (B) The chapter ranks service and humane qualities above outward distinction, so a hiring rule built only on उपाधिः/पदवी misses the real measure. Wealth and machines are not the chapter's preferred substitutes.

42. (C) Three errors compound: the object must be accusative रोगिणः with the doctor as server; the verb is आत्मनेपद सेवते not सेवति; and -वत् is 'like', not 'having'. The full correction fixes all three.

43. (D) Error one: परमः is highest in rank, not first in time. Error two: in the original service is the SUBJECT ranked highest, but the paraphrase makes 'duty' the subject and 'service' the predicate. हि is not separately mistranslated.

44. (A) The proof is the chain of choices that subordinate status to service: dropping titles, serving tirelessly yet humanely, attending the sick in person. Each distractor reverses one link of that chain.

- 45. (A)** The correct line keeps 'highest rank', specifies in-person service (not remote दान), and unites tireless stamina with humane warmth. Each distractor violates at least one of the three constraints.
- 46. (D)** Degrees and posts are possessions (what one HAS); service is an enacted, ongoing deed (what one DOES). The chapter privileges the doing over the having; the distractors invert the mapping.
- 47. (A)** Mentioning a thing is not endorsing it; here the terms are introduced only to be subordinated to service. The rebuttal exposes the leap from 'named often' to 'championed'.
- 48. (D)** Credentials, rank and wealth he already has in abundance; what is missing is humane, selfless service — the very thing the chapter crowns highest. More titles or money would not repair that lack.
- 49. (B)** The chapter's ideal fuses machine-like endurance with human warmth. B supplies the first but not the second; A supplies neither well. Neither alone is the complete model the chapter paints.
- 50. (D)** The objection is substantive, not grammatical: the chapter places service above giving, so substituting दान contradicts its ranking. दानम् can fill the slot and is a noun; it is not synonymous with सेवा.
- 51. (D)** रोगिणः is syncretic (it can be gen. sg. or acc. pl.), but the verb सेव् governs the accusative, so the object reading 'serves the sick (acc. pl.)' wins. सेव् does not take a genitive object, and the doctor remains the subject.
- 52. (A)** Agent -क builds the doer: just as चिकित्सक is 'one who heals', सेवक is 'one who serves' — the server, not the served. -इन्, -वत्, -ईय would give the wrong role or wrong kind of word.
- 53. (A)** The 'like' sense of -वत् makes यन्त्रवत् an adverb of manner, so the line says he serves machine-like (untiringly), not that he wields a machine. The instrumental sense would require a different construction and reading.
- 54. (D)** परमः is an adjective in concord with धर्मः, both nominative singular; only sandhi changes its appearance. No compound is formed — adjective + noun in agreement is a phrase, and the sandhi alone joins the surface forms.
- 55. (D)** Adjective and noun must agree in number, so the plural is परमाः धर्माः. Mixing singular with plural, or shifting to dual, breaks the required concord.
- 56. (B)** The inference works only if doing a tangible task = real service; that is the bridging assumption. The decoction reading is settled by context, no credential is in view, and the doctor does it himself, not via a delegate.

57. (C) हि strengthens, not weakens, and is not interrogative; nor is it grammatically obligatory (the sentence stands without it). For maximum force, keep it for its 'verily' emphasis.

58. (C) The correct unpacking carries every load-bearing element: highest-rank service, in-person rather than remote, tireless yet humane, above titles. Each distractor swaps the crowned value for one the chapter explicitly ranks below service.

59. (C) ध् is a voiced consonant, so the final -अः becomes ओ exactly as in परमो धर्मः, giving चिकित्सको. The विसर्ग does not stay unchanged, become र्, or drop to leave -आ before a voiced consonant.

60. (D) The chapter ranks present, personal service above remote giving, so naming the biggest donor the 'greatest servant' confuses दान with सेवा. दान is not condemned outright, nor is it the same act as सेवा merely mislabelled.